

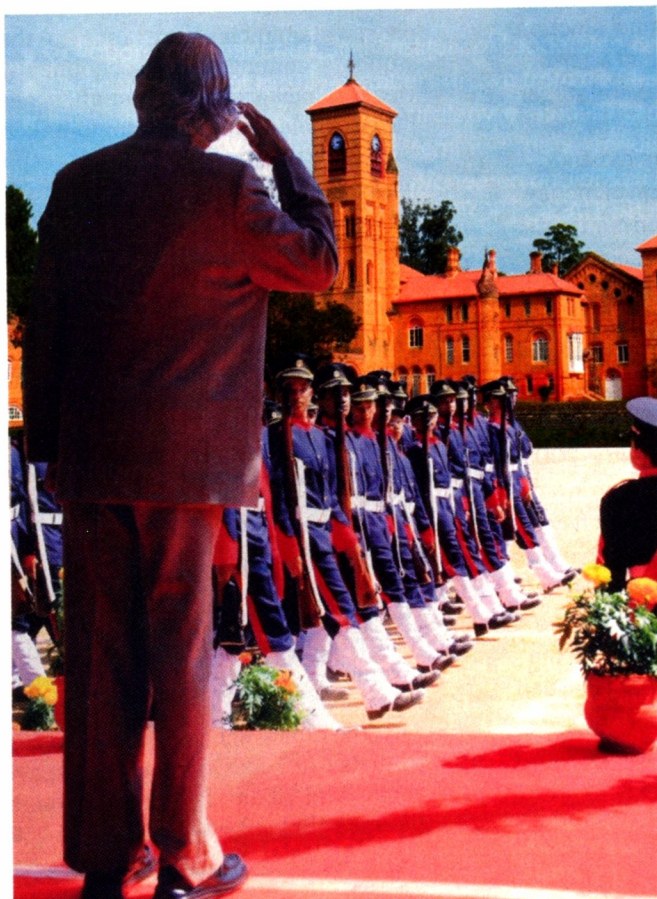


SANTOSH S. DESHPANDE

My hometown is Dharwad in Karnataka. A government servant, my father retired with an income of Rs 16,000. Understandably, finances were constrained. He did everything to give me a good education and I completed my engineering in biotechnology from BVB College of Engineering and Technology, Karnataka. I appeared for a few campus interviews but the salary offered was meagre and pursuing biotechnology would have meant more investment with no assurance of good returns. My father was about to retire in two to three years' time and there were several loans to be taken care of. I decided to pursue a course which would fetch me a good salary and an MBA was the right choice. I cleared the Symbiosis National

Aptitude Test and secured a seat for MBA in Information Technology. However, we didn't have the resources to finance the education and other expenses, the cost of which amounted to Rs 3.5 lakh. Luckily, my father's friend, who worked in Bank of Baroda, came to my rescue and agreed to give the educational loan for the whole amount without any collateral security. During the course of my study, there were times when I thought of going back home to support my family. But the phase passed soon. I completed the education and bagged the position of associate consultant with KPMG in Dubai. Recently, I returned to India to join another company to take care of my parents whose health has been deteriorating.

ROHIT PITHAURIA/www.indiatodayimages.com



The Lawrence School, Lovedale

The Lawrence School is a prestigious premier co-educational residential public School run under the aegis of the Ministry of Human Resource Development, Government of India. The School has a picturesque campus of 700 acres located at Lovedale, 6 Km from the tourist town of Ootacamund (Ooty). The School was founded on September 6, 1858 to provide sound education in the healthy/salubrious climate of the Nilgiris. The school is affiliated to the Central Board of Secondary Education and a member of the Indian Public Schools Conference.

Admission in the School is open to all. There is a reservation of 40% in seats and 30% concession in fees for the wards of Officers of Defence, Civil Servants (IAS, IPS, IFS & IRS). The school is well equipped to train students in academics and all round development with facilities available for riding, cricket, soccer, hockey, tennis, badminton, squash, basketball, archery, rifle shooting, arts & fine arts, sculpture, robotics, Indian & western music, dance, band, parade, trekking and various other activities. The School alumnae have carved a niche for themselves in every walk of life.

The school admits students in Class IV through an Entrance Examination conducted all over the country and abroad. For the academic year 2010-11, the entrance examination will be conducted on November 29, 2009 at Lovedale, Kochi, Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Delhi & Koklata. Depending upon vacancy, a few admissions are offered in classes 5 to 9 and 11. Registration is open for admission for the Academic Year 2010-11. For further details, prospective parents are requested to visit our website www.thelawrenceschool.org